

GoHighLevel Automation — Video vs. Bons Realty Build

Gap analysis & improvement report

Prepared 2026-06-16 · For: Sean Bonselaar, Bons Realty

Source video: "The Best GoHighLevel Automations for Real Estate Agents in 2026" — Noah Halpern (YouTube-ads agency)

Compared against: live GHL build docs in 01 Bons Realty/Projects/GHL/ — CLAUDE.md, Inventory.md, Integrations.md (read in full, current as of session 8, 2026-06-16)

TL;DR

The video is a **beginner-level template walkthrough** built to sell a YouTube-ads service and a GHL affiliate snapshot. Measured against it, **your build already covers roughly 80% of what it describes — and is materially more advanced** on compliance, cost control, branching, the kill-switch, long-term nurture, and the call-connect bridge. None of those exist in the video.

This is **not** a "you're behind" report. It's the specific mechanics the video uses that your build lacks, has parked, or does differently — plus where you're already ahead so you don't regress while "filling gaps." **5 genuine gaps** worth acting on, **3 already on your roadmap**, and **1 place the video is actively worse** (don't adopt it).

The video's blueprint (condensed)

One paid-lead funnel in seven pieces:

- 1 New-lead alert + opportunity creation** — form submit → create/update opportunity, drop into a pipeline stage, internal SMS alert.
- 2 Speed-to-lead SMS sequence** — instant text, then a 7-day / 11-touch cadence of simple yes/no questions, contact-timezone send window (8a–10p), small 30s humanizing waits.
- 3 Reply handling with sentiment branching** — on reply: internal alert *and* an If/Else on **positive vs negative intent**; positive → move to a **"Follow Up Now"** stage; negative → remove / do nothing.
- 4 Follow-up reminder tasks** — a daily "Follow Up Now" queue worked manually.
- 5 Appointment-booked notification** — booking → alert + opportunity → "Appointment Booked" stage.
- 6 Appointment reminders** — confirmation asking lead to **reply "YES"**, then 24h email+SMS, 2h SMS, 10-min SMS; separate cloned workflows for **phone** vs **in-person**.
- 7 Conversational AI SMS bot** — on reply, wait ~3 min, hand to Conversation AI asking scripted questions one at a time with 20s waits.

Recurring theme: **duplicate the new-lead workflow per ad source** (YouTube / FB / Google), swap only the trigger.

Coverage matrix

#	Video component	Bons status	Where it lives
1	New-lead alert + opportunity creation	Have (better)	Master Lead Router (e216a5aa) + Egen Inbound (7d7151d3) → alert to +16304470884, opp into Seller Leads/New Lead
2	Speed-to-lead SMS cadence	Have (better)	Seller Lead Follow-Up (2d6e0fab, v17) — branch-first opener, 5-min first touch, ~30-day cadence (3 email/5 SMS/5 call), GSM-7, 8a–9p/7d
3	Reply sentiment branch → "Follow Up Now"	Partial — real gap	Stop Seller Follow-Up (de4095e2, v8) stops on <i>any</i> reply; does not classify positive/negative or prioritize a stage
4	"Follow Up Now" daily task queue	Have	5 call tasks in engine + stage progression; no intent-driven "call today" stage (see #3)
5	Appointment-booked notification	Have	Appointment Status Alerts (95c6b86b, v4) → alert + confirm SMS + email
6	Appointment reminder ladder	Have, 2 gaps	3-day / 24h / 2h reminders, GSM-7, skip-if-past. Missing: reply-to-confirm + 10-min-before

#	Video component	Bons status	Where it lives
7	Conversational AI SMS bot	Built, not live	Sean–Seller Booking (SMS) (X73NjITB...) — gated, conversation-tested, global Off/non-primary; per-contact activation unverified
8	Humanizing micro-waits (30s)	Partial	Send windows + 5-min first touch; no deliberate 20–30s offset between same-moment email & SMS
9	Duplicate workflow per ad source	Have (better)	You branch on "source" in one engine instead of cloning — less drift
—	No-show / cancelled handling	Roadmap	Known TODO: 2 separate workflows (GHL can't If/Else on appt status)
—	Long-term nurture	Video has none	Long-Term Seller Nurture (8c23a04a)
—	Kill-switch / stop-on-response	Video has none	Stop Seller Follow-Up
—	A2P / opt-out / GSM-7 cost control	Video ignores	A2P approved; opt-out auto-append disabled; GSM-7 discipline; fee research
—	Call-connect auto-bridge	Video has none	Egen Inbound v12: assign Sean → whisper + press-to-connect

Genuine gaps worth acting on

P1 — Reply sentiment branching into a prioritized "Follow Up Now" stage

The one real conceptual gap. Today **any** reply fires the kill-switch and yanks the lead into Sequence-Paused + an alert — correct for *stopping the robot*, but it treats "YES call me" and "stop texting me" identically. The video classifies intent and, on **positive**, pushes the opportunity to a dedicated **Follow Up Now** stage — a clean daily call list of hand-raisers.

Recommendation: keep the kill-switch; add an intent check on reply (keyword If/Else first — cheap; Conversation-AI sentiment later) that moves positive repliers to a new **"Follow Up Now / Hot Reply"** stage on the Seller Leads pipeline. Highest-leverage change in the whole video for you.

Caveat: Conversation-AI billing is still UNVERIFIED per your fee research — start with a keyword If/Else to avoid per-message AI cost.

P2 — Reply-to-confirm on the appointment confirmation

Your flow auto-confirms and reminds, but never asks the lead to actively **reply "YES."** The video's "reply YES to confirm, otherwise I'll cancel" is a cheap no-show reducer — a micro-commitment plus a live signal of who's actually coming.

Recommendation: add a "reply YES to confirm" line to the confirm SMS/email in Appointment Status Alerts; optionally tag confirmed-repliers so unconfirmed appointments stand out. GSM-7, no opt-out language — per your rules.

P3 — 10-minutes-before final nudge

Your ladder ends at 2h. The video adds a 10-min-before "I'll be calling shortly, be by your phone" SMS, which lifts live-answer rates on phone consults.

Recommendation: add a 10-min-before SMS (skip-if-past, GSM-7) to Appointment Status Alerts. Trivial add, real connect-rate impact.

P4 — Take the Seller Booking bot live (already roadmap; video validates the pattern)

The video's headline feature — a conversational SMS bot that qualifies "while you watch Netflix" — is **exactly your Seller Booking bot**: built and conversation-tested, but global-**Off** and non-primary.

Recommendation: run the per-contact activation test you already scoped (assign bot to a test contact, text the 708, confirm the *seller* bot replies, not Emma) and confirm Conversation-AI billing before flipping it on broadly. Nothing new to design — just close it out.

P5 — Deliberate humanizing offset between simultaneous email + SMS

Minor polish, on-brand with your "reads as personal, not automated" rule. When a node sends email + SMS together (e.g. appointment confirmation), a 20–30s wait between them avoids both arriving in the same second.

Recommendation: insert short waits where email and SMS fire together — watch the send-window interaction so a wait doesn't hold a message overnight (the Call Connect proceed-time bug).

Already on your roadmap — video just reinforces it

- **No-show / cancelled workflows** — video doesn't even cover these (a weakness of the video). You already know they must be 2 separate workflows (GHL can't If/Else on appt status).
- **Egen name mapping** — unrelated to the video, still open.
- **Disable wallet "Smart Adjustment"** — cost hygiene, unrelated to the video, still pending in the UI.

Where you are already ahead — do NOT regress

The video would be a **downgrade** in several places. Don't let "filling gaps" pull you backward.

- **Compliance & cost.** The video has **zero** A2P/10DLC, opt-out, or GSM-7 awareness, and casually suggests emoji and "wait 0.5 min." Your GSM-7 discipline, disabled opt-out auto-append, and per-segment fee control are real money and deliverability — keep them.
- **One branching engine vs. cloned per-source workflows.** The video says **duplicate** the whole workflow per ad source. You correctly branch on "source" in one engine. Cloning is exactly the sprawl you spent two sessions consolidating (26 → 5). **Do not adopt the duplicate-per-source pattern.**
- **Kill-switch + long-term nurture.** Neither exists in the video. Both are core to a durable system.
- **Call-connect auto-bridge.** The video's bot impresses beginners; your auto-call → whisper → press-to-connect bridge is a tier above for actually getting you on the phone with hot leads.

Suggested order of operations

- 1 **P1** — reply sentiment branch → "Follow Up Now" stage (keyword version first; biggest payoff)
 - 2 **P4** — finish the Seller Booking bot go-live test (already scoped; video validates it)
 - 3 **P2 + P3** — reply-to-confirm + 10-min-before nudge (two small adds to 95c6b86b)
 - 4 **P5** — humanizing email/SMS offset (polish)
 - 5 Continue existing roadmap: No-Show/Cancelled workflows, Egen name split, disable Smart Adjustment
- All GHL builds per your standing rule: **snapshot the workflow JSON** → **direct backend-API edit where possible** → **AI-builder prompt only for triggers** → **re-read via API to verify** (topology, GSM-7, version bump, opt-out scrub).

Anchored to the live build docs in the GHL project folder. Figures and IDs cited are as recorded there on 2026-06-16; verify against GHL before editing.